

# ApexaiQ

## Research & Technical Documentation

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*IT Asset Management, CAASM, and Cybersecurity Hygiene*

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## 1. What ApexaiQ Does — The Problem and the Fix

ApexaiQ is a software company, founded in 2021 and headquartered in Milford, Massachusetts, with teams in the US, India, and Ireland. It builds a platform that gives organizations a single, continuously-updated view of every device and system they own — laptops, servers, cloud accounts, network gear, and IoT devices.

### The Core Problem

Large organizations accumulate thousands of devices, applications, and cloud accounts over time. IT teams gradually lose track of:

- What devices exist and who owns them
- Which ones run old, unsupported software (a security risk)
- Which ones are missing security patches
- Which ones violate compliance rules such as HIPAA or ISO 27001

This decay is called poor "IT hygiene," and it is exactly what attackers look for — an old, forgotten laptop or server is one of the easiest ways into a network. Most major data breaches trace back to an asset nobody was actively watching.

### The ApexaiQ Fix

ApexaiQ replaces "we don't know what we have" with "we know exactly what we have and how risky it is," through one dashboard that provides:

- A complete inventory of every asset
- A single risk score for the whole company (the ApexaiQ Score)
- Visibility into which assets are risky, outdated, or non-compliant
- Automated pathways to fix the problems it finds

## 2. IT Asset Management (ITAM)

IT Asset Management is the practice of tracking and managing every piece of technology a company owns, from the day it is purchased to the day it is disposed of. This spans physical assets (laptops, servers, routers, printers), software (licenses, subscriptions, SaaS apps), cloud assets (virtual machines, storage, cloud services), and network assets (firewalls, switches, IoT devices).

### Why It Matters

| Driver | Why It Matters |
|--------|----------------|
|--------|----------------|

|              |                                                                                                                       |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Security     | You cannot protect a device you don't know exists. Unknown or forgotten devices are the easiest target for attackers. |
| Cost control | Companies routinely pay for unused software licenses or buy new hardware while idle hardware already sits unused.     |
| Compliance   | Laws and standards (HIPAA, ISO 27001) require proof that systems are known and protected.                             |
| Audits       | Regulators and insurers demand accurate records fast — ITAM makes that possible.                                      |
| Planning     | Knowing what is aging lets teams budget for upgrades ahead of time, not in a panic.                                   |

Without ITAM, IT teams are effectively flying blind — this is precisely the gap ApexaiQ is built to close.

### 3. Competitive Landscape

ApexaiQ operates in the CAASM (Cyber Asset Attack Surface Management) and IT Asset Management space.

| Company         | Focus / How It Differs From ApexaiQ                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Axonius         | Focus: 1,200+ connectors reconciling asset data for security teams. Stronger on connector breadth and reconciliation; more security-team focused, less on a simple business-facing risk score.                                         |
| Lansweeper      | Focus: Deep, agentless network scanning across IT, OT, IoT, cloud. Known for raw discovery depth; ApexaiQ leans more into a simple risk score plus compliance/insurance use cases.                                                     |
| ServiceNow ITAM | Focus: Full ITSM suite with asset management built in. Much larger, more complex platform, typically for enterprises already on ServiceNow; heavier to set up.                                                                         |
| Qualys CSAM     | Focus: Asset visibility combined with vulnerability scanning. More scanner/vulnerability-first; ApexaiQ is more asset-and-score first.                                                                                                 |
| Armris          | Focus: Agentless visibility covering IoT/OT and unmanaged devices, strong in network traffic analysis. Bigger focus on real-time network/IoT security monitoring; ApexaiQ centers on asset hygiene, compliance, and one unified score. |

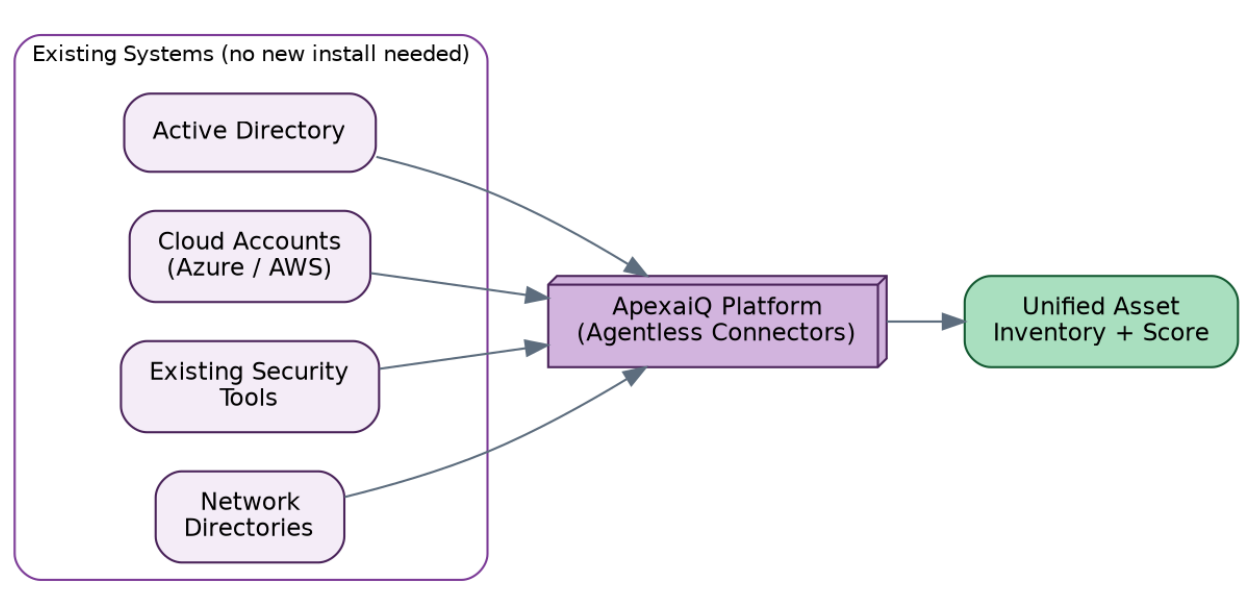
#### Partnerships (Case-Study Style Examples)

- NWN (Feb 2026) — combined ApexaiQ's asset assurance platform with NWN's managed services for one shared view across hardware, software, cloud, and network assets.
- Kyndryl (July 2025) — helping enterprises manage and secure IT assets in complex environments.
- Eficens Systems (Dec 2024) — combining continuous monitoring with automated remediation.

- Beazley (cyber insurance) — Beazley customers receive a discount on ApexaiQ, since a better asset score corresponds to lower insurance risk.

## 4. Why ApexaiQ Is Agentless

Agent-based tools require installing a small program on every device to collect data — slow to roll out, harder to maintain, and often blind to devices where nothing can be installed (some IoT devices, contractor laptops). ApexaiQ instead connects directly to systems already in place — Active Directory, cloud accounts, existing security tools, network directories — and pulls the data from there.



### Why This Matters

- Faster setup — no need to touch thousands of devices individually
- No disruption — nothing new runs on machines that could slow them down or break something
- Broader coverage — even devices that can't host an agent (old hardware, IoT, some cloud services) are still seen
- Easier maintenance — no agent software to update or troubleshoot later

This is why ApexaiQ, alongside Lansweeper, Armis, and Axonius, markets itself as agentless — a lighter, faster way to reach full visibility.

## 5. Cybersecurity Research Findings

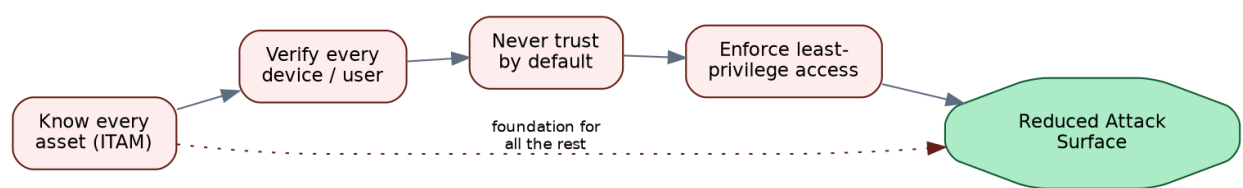
Most cyberattacks do not begin with something exotic. They begin with a known weakness nobody patched, or a forgotten device that was never removed from the network.

| Finding | Implication |
|---------|-------------|
|---------|-------------|

|                                                                                                      |                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Old, End-of-Life software stops receiving security updates                                           | One of the top root causes of breaches industry-wide                                     |
| Compliance frameworks (ISO 27001, HIPAA, CISA guidance) exist because regulators anticipate this gap | "We didn't know that system existed" is not an acceptable excuse after a breach          |
| Zero Trust has become the standard modern security approach                                          | It depends entirely on knowing your assets first — you cannot verify what you cannot see |
| Cyber insurers (e.g., Beazley) increasingly require proof of good asset hygiene for favorable rates  | A growing commercial reason companies adopt platforms like ApexaiQ                       |
| The industry is shifting from quarterly scans to continuous, real-time monitoring                    | Attackers do not wait for the next scheduled audit                                       |

## Zero Trust and ITAM

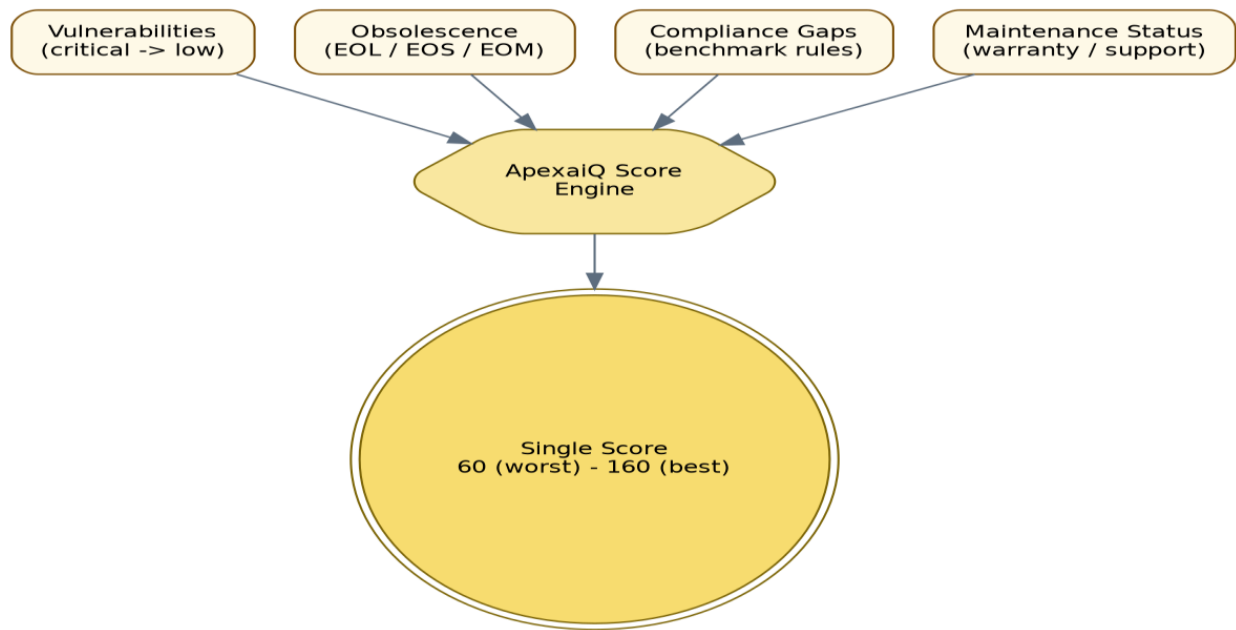
Zero Trust means never automatically trusting any device or user — even one already inside the network — and always verifying. ITAM is the foundation of Zero Trust: you cannot verify or control access for a device you don't know exists.



## 6. All Terms

### ApexaiQ Score — How the Single Number Is Built

A single number, scaled 60 to 160 like a human IQ score, summarizing how healthy and secure the whole IT estate is. Higher is safer. Think of it as a credit score, but for a company's IT.



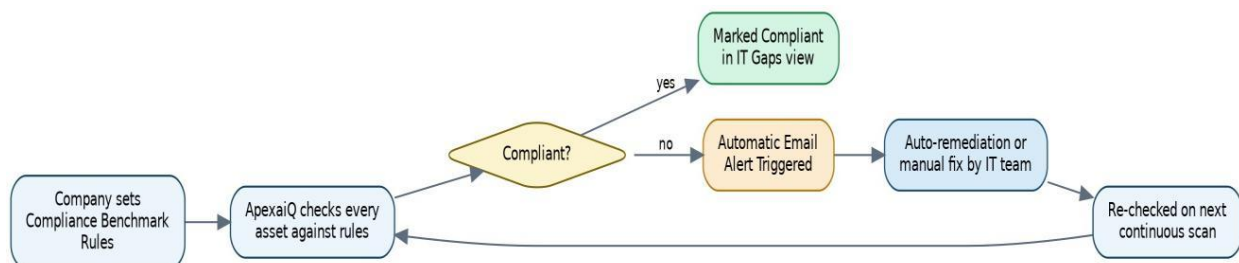
### End of Life, End of Support, End of Maintenance

- EOL (End of Life) — the maker stops selling or making the product
- EOS (End of Support) — the maker stops offering help for it
- EOM (End of Maintenance) — the maker stops releasing updates or patches for it

After these milestones pass, continuing to use the product becomes progressively riskier, since newly discovered security holes will never be fixed.

### Compliance Gaps and Remediation

ApexaiQ checks every asset against benchmark rules a company defines itself, flags non-compliant devices in the IT Gaps view, and can trigger automatic email alerts — closing the loop from detection to fix.



### Other Terms

| Term                       | Meaning                                                                       |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IT Asset Management (ITAM) | Tracking every piece of technology a company owns, from purchase to disposal. |

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vulnerabilities                       | Weak spots in software or hardware a hacker could exploit — usually bugs or missing updates.                                                          |
| Obsolescence                          | When a device or software becomes outdated — it may still run, but it is no longer safe or supported.                                                 |
| Compliance                            | Following rules set by law or industry standards, such as HIPAA (healthcare data) or ISO 27001 (security management).                                 |
| Maintenance                           | Regular upkeep — updates, patches, checks — to keep systems working safely.                                                                           |
| Asset Hygiene                         | How clean and well-managed IT records and devices are — accurate data, no forgotten devices, nothing quietly out of date.                             |
| Crown Jewel                           | The most important, most valuable systems or data in a company — the assets that cause the most damage if compromised.                                |
| Inventory                             | A complete, up-to-date list of every asset a company has.                                                                                             |
| NVD (National Vulnerability Database) | A free, US government-run database of known security vulnerabilities, used by security tools to check for known weak spots.                           |
| Patch Management                      | Finding, testing, and installing software updates that fix security holes or bugs.                                                                    |
| Data Breach                           | Unauthorized access to private or protected data.                                                                                                     |
| MSP (Managed Service Provider)        | A company hired by other businesses to run their IT — often needs tools like ApexaiQ to manage many clients at once.                                  |
| True SaaS                             | Fully cloud-based software — nothing installed on your own servers; the vendor runs and updates a single shared version for everyone.                 |
| Inbound / Outbound Integration        | Inbound: data flowing into a platform (e.g., pulling cloud account data).<br>Outbound: data flowing out (e.g., sending alerts to a ticketing system). |
| CISA                                  | US government cybersecurity agency; publishes guidelines and alerts.                                                                                  |
| CISO                                  | Chief Information Security Officer — the person in charge of a company's security.                                                                    |
| Perimeter                             | The outer edge of a company's network. Traditionally "inside" was trusted; modern security assumes that is no longer enough on its own.               |
| ROI (Return on Investment)            | The value or savings gained relative to what was spent — fewer breaches, less wasted software spend, faster audits.                                   |
| KPI (Key Performance Indicator)       | A measurable number tracking how well something is working, e.g. average time to patch a vulnerability.                                               |
| Auto-remediation                      | A system fixing a problem automatically without human intervention, e.g. isolating a risky device from the network.                                   |
| Network Protocols                     | The agreed "languages" computers use to talk to each other, such as HTTP, TCP/IP, DNS.                                                                |



|               |                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Due Diligence | Careful research before a major decision, such as checking a target company's IT security before an acquisition.                       |
| SOAR          | Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response — connects security tools together and automates the response when a threat is found. |
| CAASM         | Cyber Asset Attack Surface Management — the category of tools giving a unified view of all assets and their exposure to attack.        |